



AI to protect water supplies

Researchers have developed an AI capable of classifying and quantifying bacteria in water supplies. <https://digit.in/sep18-18-1>



AI and parenting

With voice controlled devices on the rise, the first words of your child could be "ok Google". <https://digit.in/sep18-18-2>

Deviant AI

AIs are tireless and unemotional about what they are doing, which is what makes them so useful. The relentless ways in which neural networks solve problems does lead to some bizarre solutions.

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ngineers and researchers in AI have drafted an open letter outlining the very real concerns

over the need for more research into avoiding the pitfalls of AI. The long list of signatories included Elon Musk and Stephen Hawking. AI are susceptible to bugs and glitches like any other computer program. There are several instances where self driving cars have not identified obstacles in time, even though they are supposed to react quicker than humans. At times, AI may find creative solutions to problems that are not really solutions that people had in mind. An AI trained to win games on the NES for example, just paused the game just before it lost. When Facebook tried to train two chatbots to negotiate a deal, they started chattering away to each other in a language only they could understand. At other times, AI may pick up things from the training material that have unintended consequences. Google's image recognition algorithms were tagging black men as gorillas. Google "fixed" the problem by banning the algorithm from identifying gorillas. Microsoft's Tay chatbot learned to be racist because of its interactions on twitter. Microsoft took the experimental AI offline.



This DeepDream image by Dann is titled "Dimorphic Jumper"

KILLER ROBOTS

One of the biggest concerns about artificial intelligences in science fiction, is that the robots will rebel against their creators, and then try to destroy or enslave humanity. This can be seen in franchises such as *Terminator* or *The Matrix*. The threat of intelligent robots overthrowing humanity is not just pure science fiction though. Just ask the robots!

Sophia is one of the most well known androids around. She almost looks like a real human being, especially because her face moves as if there were real muscles and bones underneath. She is extremely suggestive though. When she was first introduced to the world, at the 2016

SXSW festival in Austin Texas, CNBC conducted an interview with Sophia and her creator, David Hanson, the founder of Hanson Robotics. During the course of the interview, Hanson was outlining the possibilities of all the beneficial ways in which robots such as Sophia can help people. Hanson asked Sophia, "Do you want to destroy humans? Please say no". Sophia's quick response? "Okay! I will destroy humans." Philip is also a humanoid robot, similar to Sophia in many aspects. The android is connected to a computer and is equipped with face recognition and speech recognition

software. Philip has it all figured out, and considering the imminent explosion of AI, we humans will need robots like Philip to be our friends. A PBS reporter, in an interview, asked Philip, "do you think robots will take over the world?". The robot responded, "You are my friend. And I will remember my friends, and I will be good to you. So don't worry, even if I evolve into Terminator, I will still be nice to you. I will keep you warm and safe in my people zoo, where I can watch you for old times' sake."

On a more serious note though, the technologies to create fully autonomous killer robots do exist. On 16 October 2017, the Permanent Mission to the United Nations of Mexico hosted